

Vendor Setup — Standard Operating Procedure

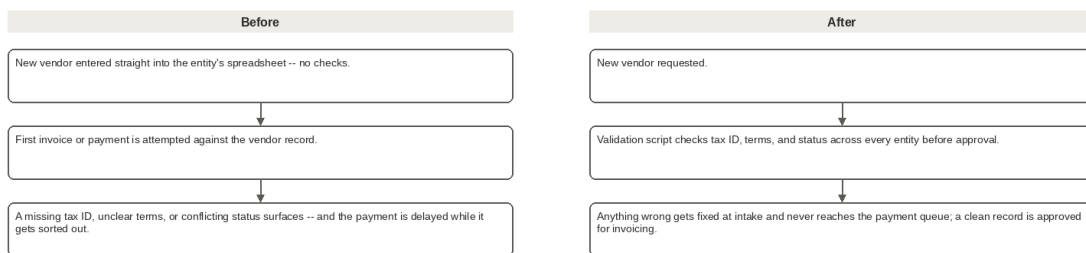
Meridian Group Data Platform Consolidation

Before this process existed, a vendor could enter the payment queue with a missing tax ID, out-of-policy terms, or a status that didn't match across entities, and nobody would catch it until a payment was already delayed. Moving the check to setup, where it's cheap to fix, instead of to payment, where it's expensive, is the entire point of this procedure.

Process

- 1 Intake — the requesting entity submits vendor name, category, proposed terms, and tax ID through the standard intake form.
- 2 Automated validation — the vendor validation script runs against the vendor master and flags a missing tax ID, terms outside the 45-day policy ceiling, an active status that disagrees across entities, or an active flag that was never recorded in the first place.
- 3 Remediation — any flagged issue goes back to the requesting entity for correction before the vendor is released to the payment cycle. Nothing proceeds on an exception basis.
- 4 Approval — once a vendor clears validation with zero flags, it's marked active and available for invoicing across every entity that uses it.
- 5 Re-validation — the same script runs against the full vendor master on a schedule, not just at intake, to catch drift, like one entity later marking a shared vendor inactive without the others being updated.

Before and after



Roles

Step	Owner
Intake	Entity finance lead
Validation run	Business Systems Analyst
Remediation	Entity finance lead (source of the flagged defect)
Approval	Business Systems Analyst